Part 1:
Proposal - Notes App

The focus of the project will be to clone the iOS Notes app. In its simplest implementation, the notes app acts as a platform where you can create, edit, store, and retrieve text files on your device. The individual notes themselves include standard text/document editor features such as sharing, font styling, keyword searching, and ‘last modified’ timestamps.

The Notes app serves the simple function of allowing users to compose text notes to themselves that are easily accessible, modifiable, and sharable. This was the chosen app for this assignment as it is a simple-enough design with clearly definable features and constraints. The process of cloning the app should provide ample experience with app creation fundamentals, practice with many universal aspects of mobile application design, and familiarity with programs that are intended to be both simple and fast to use.

The core problem this app addresses is storing information for future use. In other words, users are looking for a quick and convenient way to record information they want to remember, retrieve, or modify later. By maintaining a very minimalist and direct design approach, the Notes app provides a direct solution that audiences of almost every age and experience level can utilize. Rather than needing to carry a journal and writing utensil with you, this app consolidates all of the benefits of remembering and documenting into your phone.

In my implementation, I plan to keep the same simple and effective design philosophy used in the original app. This was a conscious design choice that reduces cognitive load for the users, and keeps the core actions tied to the app fast and hassle-free. This will manifest as retaining aspects of the app such as: the clear list layout of the initial screen for easy recognition and navigation, the icon-based button system for visually apparent user controls that neither get lost on the screen nor distract from the text, and the core functional features commonly associated with quality text-based documentation programs.

Since I will be focusing on the text editor and document retrieval aspects of the app, I will be removing the other features that are more commonly associated with other tools. While users who dedicate time can leverage these functionalities for efficient note creation, there is a noticeable trade-off in terms of interruption with the flow and formatting of your typical kinds of notes. Additionally, individuals seeking to use features like automatic calculations and hand-drawn illustrations are often going to different apps entirely for those purposes. Thus, the inclusion of these extra features, while potentially beneficial for the breadth of uses, only serves to dilute and disrupt the core functionalities and design purpose being addressed in this submission. This means removing the automatic Math Results functionalities as well as the Lines & Grids features which are more traditionally parts of spreadsheet style programs like Excel or Google Sheets. I will also be removing the Paint features used for handwritten notes, mainly due to the fact that its current implementation can be relatively unwieldy and its automatic formatting can tend to clash with the other styles of note present on the text file.